



COMM200 PERSUASIVE SPEECH

Republic Is Not Democracy

Representation without participation is oligarchy.

A system can look democratic while moving power away from citizens.

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THE CORE DECEPTION

One vote is not the same as power.

Elections can authorize rulers without giving citizens command over law, agenda, or accountability.

Elections Are Not Rule

- Res publica names a public interest.
- Officeholders define that interest from above.
- Citizens choose rulers, then disappear from command.
- No agenda power means no continuous sovereignty.

Aristotle / Rousseau / Dahl



ARGUMENT 2

Representation Replaces Participation

The direction of power is reversed.

SOURCE OF LEGITIMACY

Citizens

FILTER OF CHOICE

Parties

SITE OF DECISION

Parliament

Law appears after the options have already been managed.

Oligarchy Reproduces Itself

Oligarchy does not need
secrecy. It needs access.

- Party machines control entry.
- Economic power controls influence.
- Media visibility controls attention.
- Appointments control enforcement.

50/100

Corruption perception score / Greece

Access becomes the real constitution: who enters, who is heard,
who is protected, and who is ignored.

Accountability Breaks When Information Is Pressured

Without independent information,
citizens cannot judge power.

86/180

Press freedom rank / Greece

- Institutional pressure
- Wiretapping concerns
- SLAPP pressure
- Information control

SATISFACTION

Democracy Requires Constitutional Tools, Not Just Democratic Language.

Referendum. Initiative. Recall. Audit. Independent justice.

The Choice Is Structural

Republic as Oligarchy

- Voting ritual
- Party command
- Elite bargaining
- Opaque decisions
- Managed people

Constitutional Democracy

- Citizen rule
- Direct mandate
- Recall
- Public audit
- Accountable institutions

Power to the People

- Reject voting-only democracy.
- Demand constitutional reform.
- Demand popular referenda.
- Demand recall powers.
- Demand legislative initiative.

Representation is not participation.



SOURCES

References

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